



PENNY: HOW EASY *It* IS

Penny Balosek came from a hardworking family that “made good.”

Her grandparents had emigrated from Europe, proud to become Americans while retaining strong ethnic roots. Her grandfather started in a steel mill as a batch/melter, and eventually became a rolling machine operator. He provided a good home for his wife and several children and spoke English well, though his speech never discarded its eastern European flavor.

Penny’s father, Rudy, carried on the family heritage of working hard, and he also worked for a few years in the mill. But his goal was to have a job where he would wear a suit for work and return to his home cool and sharp. At the age of twenty-two he left the mill and took a job as a waiter in the restaurant of an upscale hotel. Within two years he was the maitre d’, and a year after that he had moved on to manage a high-end steak house downtown.

Rudy Balosek learned as much as he needed to in the next five years, and when he was thirty, got married, moved to the suburbs, and opened a family restaurant he simply called Rudolf’s. Over the